

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT SESSION

AI Prompt Literacy for Teachers

Hands-on skills for using AI effectively in lesson planning, differentiation, feedback, and daily teaching tasks — without wasting time on bad prompts

Module 2.3 • Track 2: AI in the Classroom • xvalidateai.com

Audience K–12 Teachers	Formats Workshop + Self-paced	Duration 90 min / async	Level Intermediate	Class Size 8–30 participants
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Session Overview

Many teachers have tried AI tools and found them underwhelming — vague outputs, unusable lesson plans, generic feedback that misses the point. The problem is almost never the tool. It is the prompt. This session gives teachers the frameworks and practice reps they need to get genuinely useful results from AI — not by memorising tricks, but by understanding the principles behind effective prompting.

This module is dual-format: a 90-minute live workshop with hands-on practice, and a parallel self-paced online version for teachers who cannot attend in person or who want to revisit the content at their own pace. Both formats share the same core framework, handouts, and use-case library.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this session, participants will be able to:

1	Explain why prompt quality directly determines output quality, and identify the most common prompting mistakes
2	Apply the CRAFT Framework to write structured, high-quality prompts for any teaching task
3	Use at least three AI prompting techniques — role assignment, few-shot examples, and chain-of-thought — in practical teacher contexts
4	Produce ready-to-use AI outputs for at least two real teaching tasks from their own practice
5	Critically evaluate AI outputs for accuracy, bias, and fitness for purpose before using them with students
6	Identify which tasks in their weekly workflow are high-value and low-value candidates for AI assistance

Key Concepts & Frameworks

Why Prompting Matters

AI language models do not read minds. They respond to what they are given. A vague, incomplete, or poorly structured prompt produces a vague, generic, or off-target output. A precise, context-rich prompt produces something genuinely useful. The gap between a bad AI experience and a good one is almost always the prompt — not the model.

The goal of prompt literacy is not to turn teachers into AI engineers. It is to give them just enough understanding of how these models work that they can communicate with them efficiently, iterate when needed, and recognise when an output is not fit for purpose.

The CRAFT Framework

A five-element structure for writing effective prompts. Every element improves output quality; leaving one out typically produces a noticeable drop in usefulness.

Element	What it means	Weak version	Strong version
C — Context	What situation or background does the AI need?	<i>Write a quiz</i>	<i>I teach 8th grade science. My students just finished a unit on photosynthesis and have mixed reading levels (grade 5–10).</i>
R — Role	Who or what should the AI be acting as?	<i>Answer as a teacher</i>	<i>You are an experienced middle school science teacher who writes clear, jargon-free assessments.</i>
A — Action	What specific task do you want done?	<i>Make a quiz</i>	<i>Write a 10-question multiple-choice quiz with one correct answer and three plausible distractors per question.</i>
F — Format	How should the output be structured?	<i>(not specified)</i>	<i>Format each question with the question on one line and answer choices labeled A–D on the next four lines.</i>
T — Tone/Target	Who is the audience? What register is needed?	<i>(not specified)</i>	<i>The quiz should be written at a grade 7 reading level. Avoid overly technical vocabulary unless it was explicitly taught.</i>

KEY

A complete CRAFT prompt does not need to be long. A well-structured three-sentence prompt often outperforms a rambling paragraph. Precision beats length every time.

Three Core Prompting Techniques

1. Role assignment

Giving the AI a specific role or persona dramatically narrows the response space toward useful outputs. Without a role, the model defaults to a generic assistant register that is rarely what a teacher actually needs.

Weak — no role

"Explain the water cycle to students."

Result: textbook-style explanation, no sense of audience or level.

Strong — with role

"You are an enthusiastic 4th grade science teacher known for vivid analogies. Explain the water cycle as if you are speaking to a class of 9-year-olds who have never heard the term evaporation."

2. Few-shot examples

Showing the AI one or two examples of what you want is often the fastest way to get exactly the right format, tone, or structure. Examples tell the model far more than descriptions alone.

EXAMPLE

"Write three warm-up questions for tomorrow's lesson on fractions. Here are two examples of the style I want: 1. 'If you had half a pizza and ate one quarter of it, what fraction of the whole pizza is left?' 2. 'Look at this diagram. What fraction of the shape is shaded?' Now write three more in the same style for a lesson on decimals."

3. Chain-of-thought prompting

Asking the AI to reason step-by-step before giving a final answer produces more accurate, logical, and useful outputs for complex tasks. Useful for rubric creation, feedback writing, and differentiation planning.

EXAMPLE

"I want to write a rubric for a 7th grade persuasive essay. Before writing the rubric, think through: (1) what skills a 7th grader should be developing in persuasive writing, (2) what common weaknesses look like at this level, (3) what mastery looks like. Then use that reasoning to build a four-level rubric with four criteria."

The Iteration Mindset

Effective prompting is rarely a single shot. It is a short conversation. The most useful professional habit to build is knowing when to iterate rather than accept a mediocre first output. Three iteration moves cover most situations:

When to iterate

- Output is too generic — add more context

Iteration phrases to use

- "That's a good start. Now shorten it to five bullet points and use simpler vocabulary."

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Wrong reading level — specify grade and reading level • Wrong format — describe the exact structure you want • Too long or too short — say the word count or item count • Missing your curriculum — paste in a standard or objective | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • "Rewrite question 3 so it tests evaluation, not just recall." • "Keep the same structure but make it appropriate for students with dyslexia." • "Give me an alternative version of this that takes a different angle." |
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Critical Evaluation of AI Outputs

Prompt literacy includes knowing when not to use an output. Before deploying any AI-generated content with students or in communications, teachers should run a quick three-question check:

Is it accurate?

AI models can produce plausible-sounding errors, outdated information, or fabricated references. Any factual claim, statistic, or citation must be independently verified.

Is it biased or culturally narrow?

AI outputs may reflect the dominant cultural assumptions of their training data. Names, contexts, and examples may skew toward a particular cultural background without the teacher noticing.

Is it actually fit for this class?

Generic quality is not classroom quality. An output that is factually accurate and well-written may still be wrong for your specific students, your school's context, or your learning objective.

Core Use Cases — Prompts in Practice

These five use cases form the practical core of the workshop. Each is taught with a weak-to-strong prompt transformation and then practiced hands-on. In the self-paced version, participants work through each use case with embedded prompting exercises.

UC1 Lesson Planning

Generate a full lesson outline, including objectives, hook, activities, and exit ticket

Before (weak prompt)

Write a lesson plan on fractions.

After (strong prompt)

You are a 5th grade math teacher preparing a 50-minute lesson. Students have already learned basic fractions (adding/subtracting) but are new to multiplying fractions. Write a lesson plan that includes: a 5-minute warm-up, a 15-minute direct instruction segment, a 20-minute paired practice activity, and a 10-minute exit ticket. Align to Common Core standard 5.NF.B.4. Students include three ELL learners at the intermediate level.

UC2 Differentiation

Generate tiered versions of a task for mixed-ability classrooms

Before (weak prompt)

Make this easier for struggling students.

After (strong prompt)

Here is a reading comprehension task I give to my 8th grade English class: [paste task]. Create three versions of this task: (1) a scaffolded version for students reading 2+ years below grade level, including a vocabulary glossary and sentence starters; (2) the original task as-is; (3) an extended version for students ready for more challenge that adds a synthesis question requiring them to connect the text to a second source. Keep the same core learning objective across all three.

UC3 Feedback on Student Work

Generate draft written feedback on student writing

Before (weak prompt)

Give feedback on this student essay.

After (strong prompt)

You are an experienced 10th grade English teacher who gives warm, specific, growth-oriented feedback. A student submitted the following persuasive essay: [paste essay]. The assignment asked students to argue a position on school uniform policies using at least two pieces of evidence. Write three to four sentences of written feedback that: (1) name one specific strength, (2) identify the most important area for improvement with a concrete suggestion, and (3) end with an encouraging question to push their thinking further. Do not rewrite the essay for the student.

UC4 Rubric & Assessment Design

Build a multi-criteria rubric aligned to a specific objective

Before (weak prompt)

Make a rubric for a science project.

After (strong prompt)

I teach 6th grade earth science. Students are completing a five-minute oral presentation on one type of severe weather. Create a four-level rubric (Exceeds, Meets, Approaching, Beginning) with four criteria: scientific accuracy, use of evidence, clarity of explanation, and presentation skills. For each criterion at each level, write one or two sentences describing what the student demonstrates. Base the 'Meets' level on grade-level expectations from the Next Generation Science Standards for 6th grade.

UC5 Parent & Administrative Communication

Draft professional communications quickly

Before (weak prompt)**After (strong prompt)**

Write an email to parents about the science fair.

You are a 7th grade science teacher drafting a brief email to families about the upcoming science fair. The fair is on Thursday 15 May from 6–8 pm in the school gymnasium. Students must bring their completed display boards and be ready to present. Families are welcome to attend. The tone should be warm and welcoming, not overly formal. The email should be no longer than 150 words. Include a subject line.

Workshop Agenda (90 minutes)

Time	Segment	Activity	Format	Materials
0–8 min	Welcome & framing	Why your prompts are the problem (not the AI) — three live demos of the same task with weak vs. strong prompts	Facilitator demo	Slides, live AI access
8–20 min	The CRAFT Framework	Introduce each element with worked examples; participants annotate a sample prompt	Input + guided notes	CRAFT one-pager
20–35 min	Technique workshop	Demonstrate role assignment, few-shot, and chain-of-thought with teacher examples. Participants write one prompt using each.	Guided practice	Technique card, laptops
35–55 min	Use-case practice rounds	Pairs choose two use cases from the menu and work through weak→strong prompt transformation, then generate a real output	Pair work	Use-case cards, laptops
55–68 min	Your own task — live	Each participant prompts for something from their actual week. Facilitator circulates and coaches.	Individual practice	Laptops, CRAFT card
68–78 min	Critical evaluation practice	Pairs examine two AI outputs (pre-prepared) and identify errors, bias, and fitness issues using the three-question check	Pairs	Sample output sheets
78–86 min	Reflection & share-out	What worked? What surprised you? Biggest time-saving opportunity identified.	Whole group	—

86–90 min	Wrap-up & next steps	Prompt Library handout, self-paced module link, 30-day challenge card	Facilitator close	All handouts
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Activities — Facilitator Guide

A1 Opening Demo: Same Task, Three Prompts

Workshop

8 minutes

Before introducing any framework, the facilitator runs three live AI generations of the same teaching task using progressively better prompts. This creates the motivation for everything that follows: participants see with their own eyes how dramatically prompt quality affects output quality.

1. Prompt 1 (bare): "Write a quiz on World War II." Show the output. Ask: would you use this tomorrow? Take hands.
2. Prompt 2 (partial): "Write a 10-question multiple choice quiz on World War II for 8th graders." Show the output. Compare.
3. Prompt 3 (full CRAFT): Read aloud a fully structured prompt for the same task. Show the output. Compare.
4. Ask participants: what did you notice changing between prompt 1 and prompt 3? Capture 3–4 observations on the whiteboard.
5. Bridge: "Every one of those improvements came from giving the AI more of what it needs to help you. That's what we're going to build today."

A2 CRAFT Annotation Exercise

Workshop

12 minutes

Participants receive a printed sample prompt (strong, fully-structured) and annotate it by identifying each CRAFT element. Then they rewrite a weak prompt from their own subject area using the framework. The goal is to shift from passive understanding to active application in a low-stakes environment.

6. Distribute the CRAFT one-pager and the sample prompt annotation sheet (one page, two prompts to annotate).
7. Participants annotate individually: label each sentence or clause with C, R, A, F, or T (5 min).
8. Pair check: compare annotations with a neighbour. Where do you agree? Where is the line blurry? (3 min).
9. Facilitator reviews the 'tricky' elements — context vs. format is the most common confusion. Clarify: Context is background information; Format is the structure of the output.
10. Transition: participants now write one CRAFT-structured prompt for a task from their own class. They will use it in A3.

A3 Use-Case Practice Rounds

Workshop

20 minutes

Working in pairs, participants choose two use cases from the five-card menu and work through the full weak-to-strong transformation. They must actually generate an output using the strong

prompt and evaluate whether they would use it. This is the highest-value practice segment of the session — protect the time.

11. Pairs select two use-case cards most relevant to their own teaching context.
12. Round 1 (8 min): Each person reads the weak prompt, predicts what the output will look like, then rewrites it using CRAFT. They generate the output and assess it with the three-question check.
13. Round 2 (8 min): Repeat with the second use case. Encourage applying one of the three techniques (role, few-shot, chain-of-thought) deliberately.
14. Share-out (4 min): Facilitator asks two or three pairs: “What was the biggest improvement you made in your rewrite?” Surface the pattern: specificity, role, and format are the most common high-leverage changes.

A4 Your Own Task — Live Practice

Workshop

13 minutes

Each participant opens a real AI tool and prompts for something they actually need for their class this week. This is intentionally open and personal. The facilitator’s job is to circulate, read over shoulders, and offer one coaching question per participant: “What’s missing from this prompt?”

15. Participants open their preferred AI tool (or a shared class account if devices are limited).
16. They write a CRAFT prompt for a real task — something they would otherwise spend 20–30 minutes on.
17. Facilitator circulates with the coaching question: “Read me your prompt. What did you tell it about your students?”
18. Participants iterate at least once based on facilitator feedback or their own judgment.
19. Participants who finish early: write a second prompt using the technique they haven’t tried yet (role / few-shot / chain-of-thought).

A5 Critical Evaluation: Spot the Problem

Workshop

10 minutes

Pairs receive two pre-prepared AI-generated outputs (embedded in the handout) and must identify at least one issue in each using the three-question check. Outputs are intentionally chosen to have subtle, non-obvious problems — a plausible factual error, a culturally narrow example set, and a correct-but-not-fit-for-purpose response.

20. Distribute the Critical Evaluation handout (two sample outputs with annotation space below each).
21. Pairs work through both outputs in 6 minutes: identify the problem, explain what they would do about it (re-prompt, edit, or discard).
22. Facilitator debrief (4 min): reveal the planted issues. Key message: “AI outputs are drafts, not final products. Your professional judgment is the last quality gate.”

Self-Paced Online Version — Structure

The self-paced version of this module mirrors the workshop content across five short online units. Each unit takes 15–25 minutes and includes a short video, guided reading, embedded practice prompts, and a reflection check-in. Participants can complete units in one session or spread them across a week.

Unit	Title	Core content	Practice task	Time
1	Why Prompts Matter	How LLMs work (simplified); why specificity drives quality; the three most common prompting mistakes	Rate 5 real prompts on a quality scale and explain your ratings	15 min
2	The CRAFT Framework	Each element explained with examples; annotate a sample prompt; build your first CRAFT prompt	Write a CRAFT prompt for a lesson planning task of your choice	20 min
3	Three Power Techniques	Role assignment, few-shot examples, chain-of-thought: video demo + guided practice for each	Apply one technique to improve a weak prompt from a provided set	20 min
4	Use-Case Library	Work through three use cases from the five-case menu; generate real outputs; evaluate each	Complete the weak→strong transformation for two use cases; save the outputs	25 min
5	Critical Evaluation & Habits	The three-question check; building a sustainable prompting habit; when not to use AI	Complete the critical evaluation exercise; write your 30-day prompting goal	15 min

Participant Handouts — Content

Handout 1: The CRAFT Prompt Framework — Quick Reference Card

FORMAT This is designed as a double-sided A5 laminated card. Front: the CRAFT table below. Back: the five use-case prompt starters.

Letter	Element	What to include	Example phrase to use
C	Context Subject, grade, prior knowledge, student needs, curriculum standards	Subject, grade, prior knowledge, student needs, curriculum standards	<i>"My 7th grade class just finished... Students include..."</i>
R	Role Who the AI should be for this task	Who the AI should be for this task	<i>"You are an experienced 9th grade history teacher who..."</i>
A	Action The specific task, with any constraints	The specific task, with any constraints	<i>"Write a 5-question formative quiz that... Do not include..."</i>

F	Format The exact structure of the output	The exact structure of the output	<i>"Format as a table with columns for... / Use bullet points / Number each item"</i>
T	Tone/Target Audience, reading level, register	Audience, reading level, register	<i>"Written at a grade 5 reading level / Warm and conversational / Formal enough for parents"</i>

Handout 2: Starter Prompt Library — 20 Prompts for Common Teaching Tasks

NOTE These are starting-point prompts. Each should be personalised with your grade, subject, and student context before use. The [brackets] indicate where to insert your specific details.

Lesson Planning

Write a [duration]-minute lesson plan for [subject] grade [grade]. Topic: [topic]. Students have previously learned [prior knowledge]. Include a hook, direct instruction, a student activity, and an exit ticket. Align to [standard].

You are an experienced [subject] teacher. Design a project-based learning activity for [topic] that spans [timeframe]. Include a driving question, student roles, a product or performance, and a simple rubric.

Differentiation

Here is my original task: [paste task]. Create three versions: (1) scaffolded for students 1–2 years below grade level with vocabulary support and sentence starters, (2) grade-level original, (3) enrichment extension for advanced learners.

List five strategies for supporting [specific need — e.g., ELL students at the intermediate level] during a lesson on [topic] in [subject] at [grade level]. Be specific and practical, not general.

Assessment & Feedback

You are a [grade] [subject] teacher. Write [number] multiple-choice questions on [topic] with one correct answer and three plausible distractors each. Align to [standard]. Target Bloom's level: [recall/understanding/application/analysis].

A student submitted the following work: [paste work]. The assignment was: [describe assignment]. Write warm, specific written feedback that identifies one strength, one area for improvement with a concrete suggestion, and one question to push their thinking.

Write a four-level rubric (Exceeds/Meets/Approaching/Beginning) for [assignment type] in [grade] [subject]. Criteria: [list 3–4 criteria]. Base 'Meets' on grade-level expectations.

Communication

- Write a brief, warm email to families announcing [event/update]. Include: [key details]. Keep it under [word count] words. Tone: [formal/warm/urgent]. Include a subject line.
- Draft a parent communication for a student who is [describe situation — e.g., struggling with homework completion]. Tone should be collaborative and non-accusatory. Invite a conversation. Keep it under 200 words.

Professional Planning

- I need to prepare for a parent-teacher conference for a student who [brief description of situation]. Help me prepare: (1) three key points to communicate, (2) one area of growth to celebrate, (3) two specific suggestions for the family to support learning at home.
- I have [timeframe] to teach [topic] to [grade] [subject]. Help me sequence the learning across [number] lessons. For each lesson, give a one-line objective and one key activity.

Handout 3: My AI Workflow Planner

Use this to identify where AI assistance can save the most time in your weekly workflow. Be honest: not every task benefits from AI.

Task I do regularly	Time it currently takes	AI-assist potential (High/Med/Low)	Which CRAFT use case applies?

REFLECTION

My highest-value AI task this week: _____
My first CRAFT prompt to write after this session: _____ One task I will NOT use AI for, and why: _____

Materials & Preparation Checklist

Item	Description	When needed
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Slide deck	Workshop slides with live demo prompts, CRAFT visual, activity prompts, and timers	Before session
Live AI access	Each participant needs access to an AI tool — ChatGPT, Claude, Copilot, or Gemini. Arrange shared accounts if school devices block these.	Before session
CRAFT quick-reference card (H1)	Printed, ideally laminated A5. One per participant.	Before session
Starter Prompt Library (H2)	Printed A4, double-sided. One per participant.	Before session
My AI Workflow Planner (H3)	Printed single sheet. One per participant.	Before session
Sample prompt annotation sheets	Two weak prompts for A2 annotation exercise, printed.	Before session
Use-case practice cards	Five cards (one per use case) with weak prompt, context, and space to rewrite. Print one set per pair.	Before session
Critical evaluation sheets	Two pre-prepared AI outputs (with planted errors) for A5. Print one per pair.	Before session
30-day challenge card	Small card with the three challenge options for follow-through. Print one per participant.	End of session

Facilitation Notes & Common Scenarios

Technology Logistics

This session requires live AI access. Plan for three possible scenarios:

- Devices available, unrestricted internet: ideal. Participants use their preferred tool.
- School devices with content filters: test your AI tools on school devices before the session. Many school filters block AI tools. Set up a shared facilitator account projected on screen if needed.
- No devices: the session can run with printed prompt examples and a single facilitated live demo. Participants write prompts on paper and the facilitator generates outputs on the main screen.

Anticipated Participant Reactions

“I tried AI and it was useless.”

This is the most common entry point. Ask: “What prompt did you use?” Almost always, they used a one-line bare prompt. The entire opening demo is designed for this person. Do not dismiss the frustration — validate it and then redirect: “That’s the most common experience, and it’s a prompt problem, not a tool problem.”

“This will take me longer than doing it myself.”

True for simple tasks; false for complex or repetitive ones. Redirect to the workflow planner: “What task do you do every week that takes 20+ minutes?” Lesson planning, rubric building, and feedback writing are almost always on that list. A well-structured prompt for any of those tasks takes 2–3 minutes.

“What if students see me using AI to plan their lessons?”

Reframe: professional use of AI tools is no different from using a textbook, a curriculum guide, or a colleague’s template. What matters is the professional judgment applied before using the output with students. The critical evaluation section addresses this directly.

“Does it matter which AI tool I use?”

Acknowledge real differences exist (capability, cost, school policy). For the purposes of this session, the CRAFT framework and techniques apply to all major AI tools. Recommend participants use whatever tool their school has approved or made available.

Coaching Moves for A4 (Live Practice)

During the live practice round, the facilitator’s most effective moves are:

- Read the prompt silently, then ask: “What did you tell it about your students?” — This is the most common missing element.
- If the output is mediocre: “Don’t start over — just add one more sentence to the prompt. What’s the one thing the AI didn’t know?”
- If the output is surprisingly good: “What specifically made that work? Name the CRAFT element that did the most work.”
- For reluctant participants: “Tell me about a task you dread doing every week.” Use that as the practice prompt.

Follow-Through & Platform Connection**30-Day Prompting Challenge (choose one)**

Daily habit: Use AI with a CRAFT prompt for at least one task every school day for 30 days. Keep a two-sentence note on whether the output was usable.

Use-case master: Work through all five use cases in the library, generating at least one real, usable output for each. Share the best one with a colleague.

Prompt sharer: Write three prompts that worked well and share them with your department or team. Contribute them to the school’s shared prompt library on xvalidateai.com.

Connection to xvalidateai.com Platform

Completed workflow planners and the 30-day challenge log can be uploaded to the school’s xvalidateai dashboard as evidence of AI literacy professional development. Schools building a shared prompt library can host it within the platform’s resource section, making high-quality teacher prompts available across the whole staff.

Related Modules in the PD Series**Recommended before this session**

- 1.1 AI Self-Literacy Assessment
- 1.2 How AI Actually Works — A Practical Primer
- 1.3 AI Tools Landscape for Educators

Recommended after this session

- 2.1 Designing AI-Resilient Assessments
- 2.2 Teaching Students to Use AI Responsibly
- 3.2 Bias, Fairness & AI in Education

- 3.3 Student Data Privacy in the Age of AI

TIP

This session is one of the highest-engagement modules in the curriculum because participants produce something immediately useful. Schedule it early in the year so teachers have time to build prompting habits before the busiest grading periods.